raygency

WEBINAR · THE MESSY PART OF AI · 45 MINUTES

Your customers already asked. You weren't in the answer.

SEO, AEO and GEO in plain words, what our agent found when it asked five assistants about one brand, and how to put a number on being named.

Varun Tyagi · Raygency

November 6, 2026 · hosted by Renuka Adnani · raygency.com

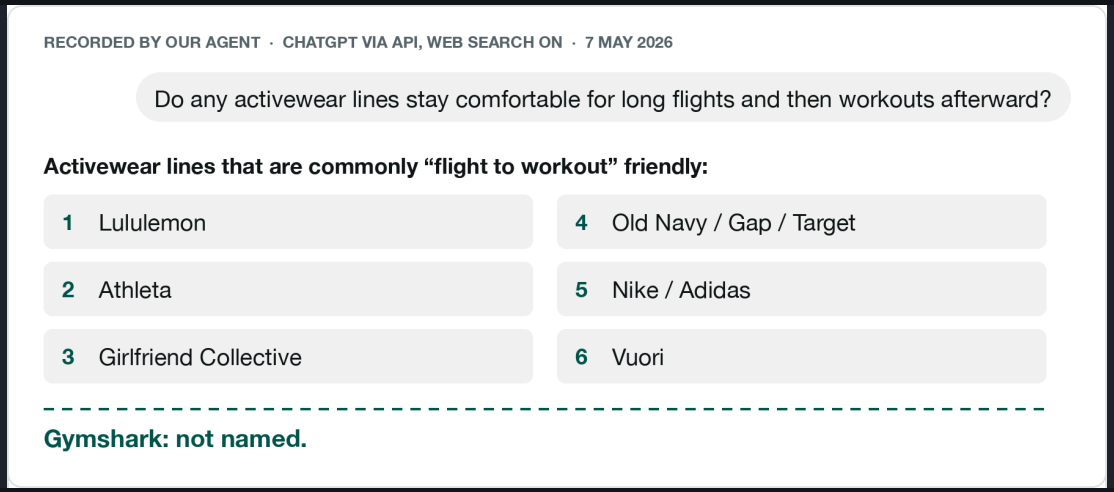
THE NEXT 45 MINUTES

Four blocks, one question

0:00	**You ask an assistant about your category**	Before I say a word about it
0:06	**1 · The shortlist replaced the search**	Five numbers that say your buyer already moved
0:13	**2 · SEO, AEO, GEO in plain words**	What each one is, and how an assistant decides who to name
0:23	**3 · What our agent found**	One real brand, five assistants, five months apart
0:32	**4 · Putting a number on it**	The ROI ladder, three honest limits, and Monday morning

THE MOMENT

Six brands named. Gymshark wasn't one.



A question any traveller asks. Our agent put it to ChatGPT on 7 May 2026 and kept the answer exactly as it came back.

BEFORE WE START

Ninety seconds, three ways in

A · RUN IT

ChatGPT, logged out

A private window, so your own history doesn't get a vote.

B · LITE

Any assistant on your phone

Gemini, Claude, Perplexity, Copilot. Same question, smaller screen.

C · WATCH

Follow on screen

Shout a category in the chat and I run it live for you.

CHECKPOINT Type your letter in the chat. A, B or C.

YOUR TURN · 3 MIN

Ask it what your buyer asks

TYPE THIS

> What are the five best [your category] brands for [your kind of customer]? Give one reason for each.

One rule: never type your own brand name. Your buyer wouldn't. Then read who made the five, and the reason it gave.

CHECKPOINT In the chat: were you in the five? Yes, no, or who was.

01

The shortlist replaced the search

Hotel guests stopped reading the guidebook. They ask the concierge, and they go where the concierge sends them.

51%

of B2B software buyers now start in a chatbot more often than in Google.

Eleven months earlier it was 29%. Your buyer moved before your budget did.

G2, The Answer Economy: 2026 AI Search Insight Report, n = 1,076, surveyed March 2026, published April 2026.

WHY NOW

Three numbers your board should know

58%

Fewer clicks on Google's number one

When an AI Overview sits above it. 300,000 keywords, December 2023 against December 2025.

69%

Changed vendor because of the chatbot

Buyers who picked a different vendor than planned, after the assistant's advice.

2.5B

See AI Overviews every month

Google's own figure, May 2026. Your buyer meets an AI answer whether they chose one or not.

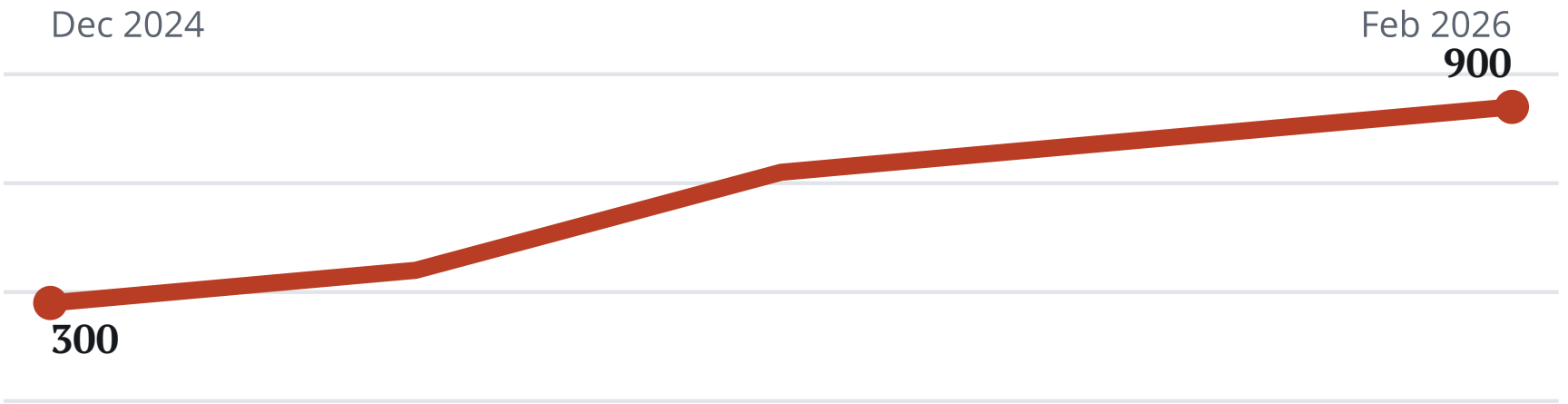
✓

Test like a buyer

Logged out, a fresh chat, never your brand in the prompt, five runs. Your history tells it you already like you.

Ahrefs, updated February 2026 · G2, The Answer Economy, n = 1,076, April 2026 · Google I/O keynote, 19 May 2026.

One concierge desk tripled in fourteen months



300 million to 900 million a week. And that is one assistant of five.

OpenAI via TechCrunch, 27 February 2026. Five announced points, spaced by announcement, not by month.

0.19%

of US web traffic comes from AI assistants. The decision isn't tiny.

So nobody on your team is watching it. But the vendor that wins was on the Day One shortlist 95% of the time. The click was never where the decision happened.

StatCounter, US, September 2026 · 6sense, 2025 B2B Buyer Experience Report, November 2025.

02

SEO, AEO, GEO, in plain words

The guidebook ranks every restaurant in town. The concierge names three.

THE VOCABULARY

Three names, three different wins

SEO

Rank on the list

Search engine optimisation. Ten blue links, and you win a position the buyer clicks. You measure rank and clicks.

AEO

Be the answer

Answer engine optimisation. The engine answers in a box, a snippet or a voice, and you win by being the source it quotes.

GEO

Be chosen by the model

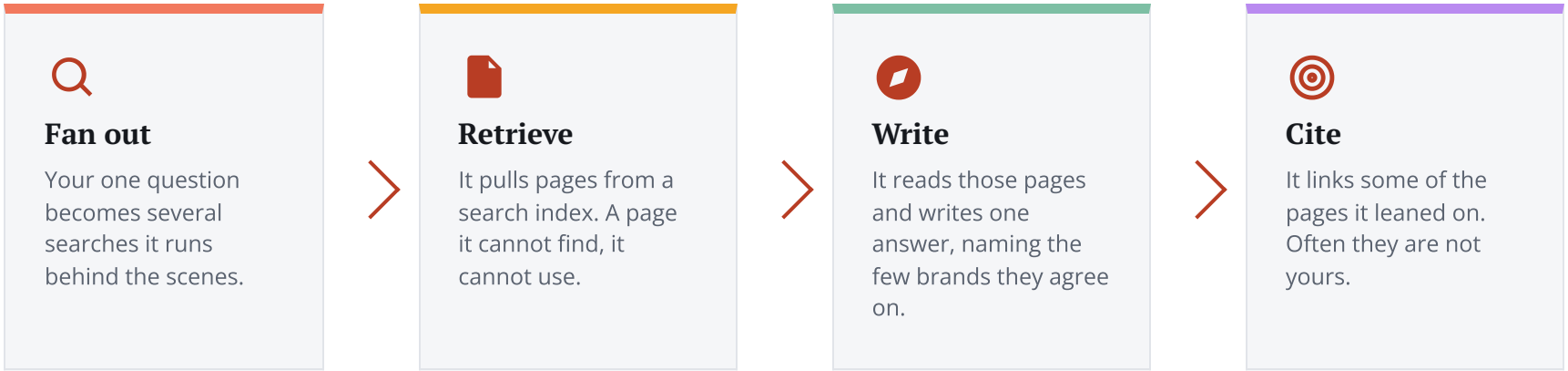
Generative engine optimisation. ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude or Perplexity writes a new answer and names a few brands. You win by being named.

They stack. GEO needs AEO, and AEO needs the SEO you already pay for.

There is no position number two in an answer.

On a results page, the fourth link still gets a look. In an answer, you are named or you are not, and the buyer never sees the brands that were not.

How an assistant builds its answer



Every step is a place to drop out. Most brands drop out before the writing starts.

WHERE IT READS

Each assistant reads a different library

47.9%

Wikipedia, in ChatGPT

Of the top ten sources ChatGPT cites. Your Wikipedia entry can outweigh your homepage.

46.7%

Reddit, in Perplexity

Of Perplexity's top ten sources. Forum threads, not brand pages.

21%

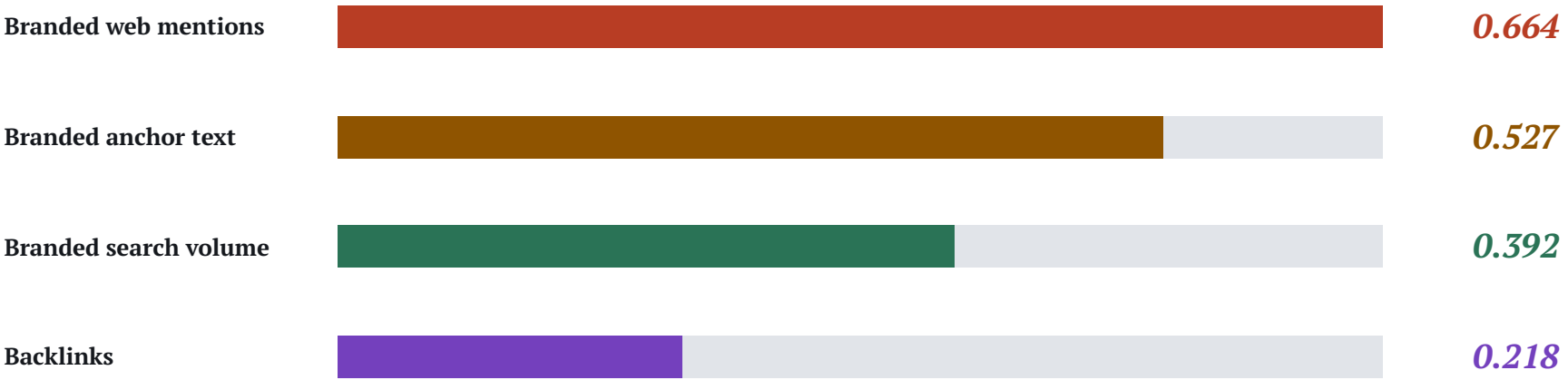
Reddit, in Google's AI Overviews

Of their top ten sources. Even Google's own answer leans on forum threads.

Profound, AI platform citation patterns, 680 million citations, August 2024 to June 2025, updated August 2025. Share of each platform's top ten cited sources.

WHAT IT REWARDS

Being talked about beats being linked to



Correlation, not cause. The order is still the lesson.

Ahrefs, AI Overview brand visibility factors, 75,000 brands, Spearman correlation, August 2025.

WHAT MOVES IT

Write the sentence you want quoted

1

Add a quotation

A named expert or a named customer. Plus 41% visibility in the GEO study, KDD 2024.

2

Add a statistic

A specific, dated number with its source. Plus 31% in the same study.

3

Start with five pages

The five buyers already land on. Swap one adjective in each opening for a number. Keyword stuffing showed no lift.

The assistant can only repeat what somebody wrote down.

Give it a sentence worth repeating, on your site and on the sites that write about you.

03

What our agent found

We sat in the lobby for five months and wrote down every name the concierge gave.

What our agent did while I was asleep

Write

Read the brand and wrote 18 questions a buyer asks, never naming the brand.

Ask

Put every question to five engines, with web search switched on.

Score

Named or not, cited or not, and who else made the answer.

Find the gaps

The questions where a rival is named and you aren't.

Ninety answers, scored, while nobody watched. The same agent is in your kit.

1 of 18

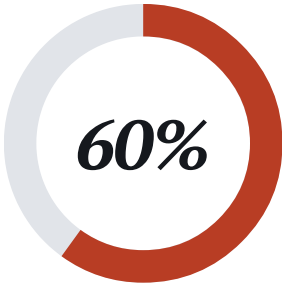
ChatGPT named Gymshark once. In May, and again in October.

Same score both times, on a different question each time. Claude named it on 5 of 18, Gemini on 4 of 17.

Raygency agent runs, 7 May and 17 October 2026. Same 18 questions, same models, API with web search on.

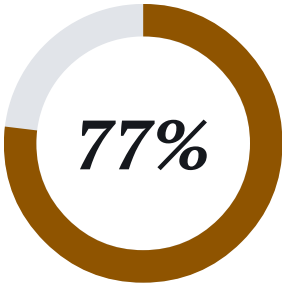
WHAT THE AGENT FOUND

Most answers name nobody. Almost none cite you.



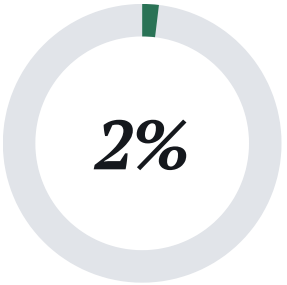
Named no brand at all

32 of 53 answers in October. 30 of 54 in May.



Cited sites new since May

The ground under the answer moved in five months.



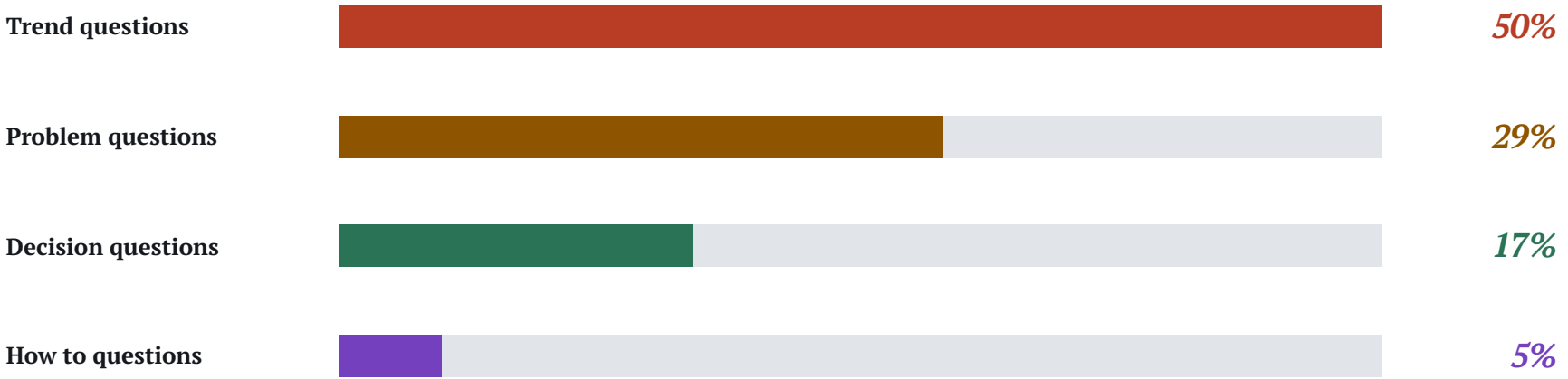
Citations to gymshark.com

4 of 232 in October. The answer is written from other people's pages.

Raygency agent runs, Gymshark, 7 May and 17 October 2026. ChatGPT, Claude and Gemini; citations include Perplexity.

WHERE THE GAP IS

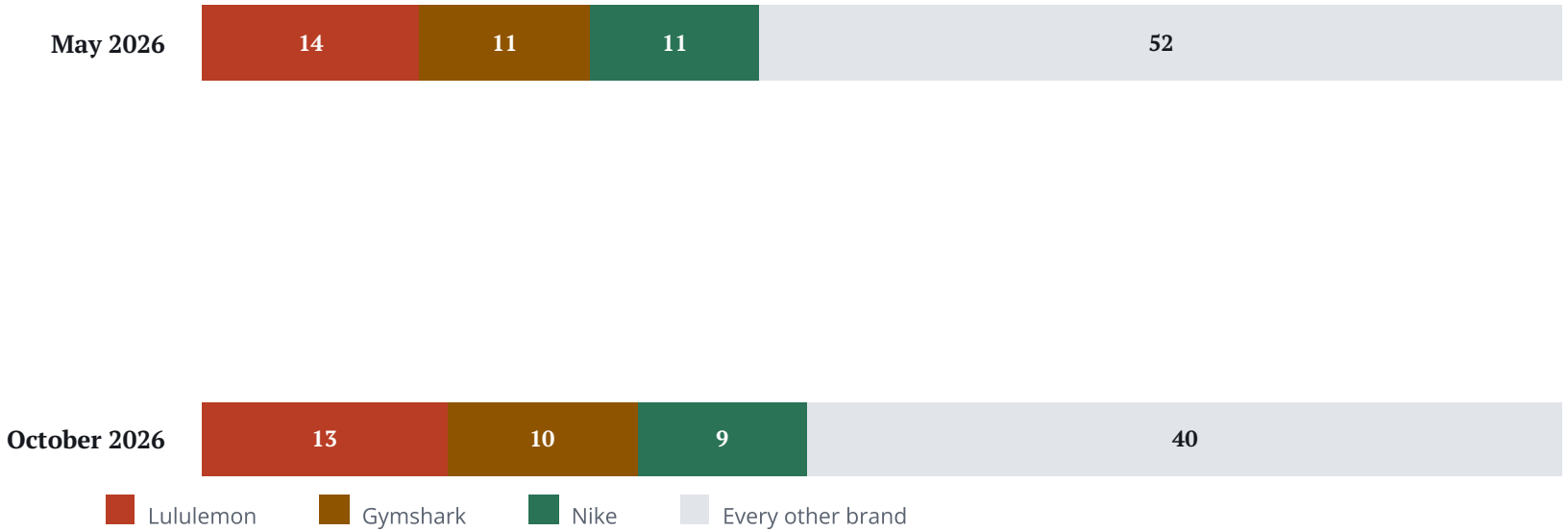
Gymshark wins trend questions, vanishes on how to



How to questions were 42 of the 107 answers. Gymshark made two. That gap is content, not ads.

Share of answers naming Gymshark, by question type. Both runs, ChatGPT, Claude and Gemini, 107 answers.

Same three names on top, five months apart



Brand mentions across ChatGPT, Claude and Gemini answers: 88 in May, 72 in October. Raygency agent runs, 2026.

Two shortcuts from running this for real

1

Five runs, never one

ChatGPT gave Gymshark the same score in May and October, on a different question each time. A single check is a coin toss, so ask the same questions five times and count.

2

Start with the how to questions

They were 42 of the 107 answers and Gymshark made two. Write the guide your buyer is asking for, and put a number in its first line.

Both are in the agent in your kit. It runs the five and splits the score by question type.

04

Ask every table who sent them

The restaurant that wants more bookings from the concierge starts by counting the ones it already gets.

THE ROI LADDER

Measure the bottom rung first

Pipeline	Deals and orders where the buyer says an assistant sent them
Visits	A GA4 channel for AI, and Search Console's generative AI report
Preference	Named first, named with a reason, named over the rival you lose to
Presence	Share of answers naming you: twenty questions, five runs, every month

Every rung stands on the one below it. Most teams start at the top.

WHAT EACH TOOL SEES

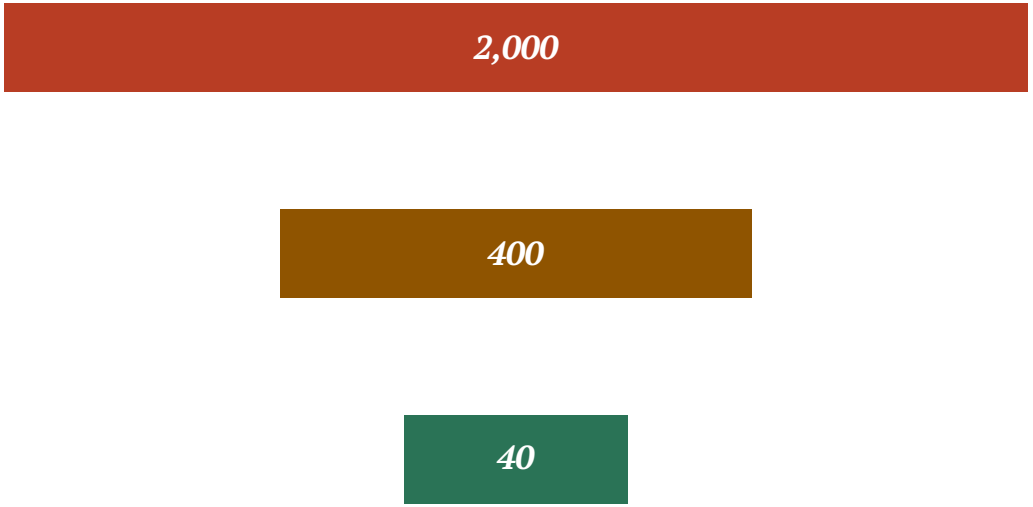
No single tool sees the whole ladder

TOOL	WHAT IT SEES	WHAT IT MISSES	COST
Monthly presence run	Whether you're named	What happens next	Two hours, or the agent
Search Console AI report	Impressions in Google AI	Clicks, queries, other assistants	Free
GA4 AI channel	Visits with a referrer	Apps that strip it	Free, ten minutes
"How did you hear?"	What the buyer remembers	People who skip the field	Free, one form field

Read the four side by side, every month. Each one covers another's blind spot.

A MODEL, NOT A CASE STUDY

Where two thousand buyers go



Ask an assistant about your category
A month. Your sales team's estimate goes here

See you in the answer
At 20% presence, from your twenty question baseline

Become customers
At a 10% shortlist win rate

Illustrative inputs, not measured. Bars are not to scale; the numbers are. The worksheet in your kit runs it on yours.

A MODEL, NOT A CASE STUDY

What a shortlist is worth, on your numbers

THE LINE	WHERE IT COMES FROM	WORKED EXAMPLE
Buyers asking, a month	Your sales team's estimate	2,000
Answers naming you	Your twenty question baseline	20%, so 400
Become customers	Your shortlist win rate	10%, so 40
Value per customer	Your average order	€120, so €4,800
Presence up to 35%	The target you set	+30 customers, +€3,600

Every input is a placeholder. The worksheet in your kit does this arithmetic on yours.

The concierge now books the table.

Shopify opened checkout to AI agents on 28 September. Google's agent commerce hub reached US Merchant Center on 6 October. When the assistant buys, there is no click to measure. Being in the answer is what survives.

MONDAY MORNING

Three things to switch on this week

1

A GA4 channel for AI

One rule catches ChatGPT, Perplexity, Gemini, Claude and Copilot visits. It is in your kit, ready to paste.

2

Search Console's AI report

Impressions only, no clicks, no queries. Still Google's first number on AI search. Bookmark it.

3

One option on your form

"How did you hear about us?" with "ChatGPT or another AI assistant". Assistants often hide the referrer.

Thirty minutes of setup, and next month you have a baseline to beat.

WHERE THIS BREAKS

Three things I'd get wrong if I oversold this

01

Google says it is still SEO

Google's own guide, May 2026: no special markup and no llms.txt needed for its AI features. The fundamentals you already pay for still count. Don't buy a second programme to replace them.

02

AI visitors don't automatically convert better

The largest study so far, 973 shops in Marketing Science 2026: Google organic converted about 13% better than ChatGPT referrals. The value is the shortlist, not the visit.

03

The numbers move, and most of them are sold to you

Answers change from run to run. Most AI visibility data comes from companies who sell tracking, and that includes us. Measure your own: the same questions, five runs, every month.

BEFORE YOU GO

Three things to take with you

1

Keep the kit

The AEO skills, the prompt pack, the ROI worksheet and the questions for your team. One link, in the chat now.

2

Keep the rule

Check your shortlist like a buyer, every month, five runs. Your first run is the baseline you beat.

3

Run the agent on your brand

Skill 01 in the kit asks your buyers' questions across five assistants. Run it by 27 November and reply to Varun's follow up email with your score.

Right now an assistant is answering a question about your category.

Nobody on your team has read the answer.